

REVIEW OF BGI'S OBJECTIVES

Note by Peter Owen

At the last meeting it was agreed that we should review the objectives of the group. These are currently set out in the "Our Work" section of the website as follows:

The Better Government Initiative stands for ...

1. A robust policy making process that

- is open, consultative and evidence based
- ensures policies are trialled and tested and
- is built to last.

2. Open and transparent government with a presumption in favour of

- disclosure of all data and
- publication of impact statements and business cases.

3. Simple legislation responding to clearly identified needs with

- close scrutiny of the case for legislation
- explicit standards for the preparation of legislation
- a Parliamentary process to ensure consistent application of those standards.

4. Effective accountability of Government with

- greater continuity of responsibility for both Ministers and officials and
- effective Parliamentary scrutiny of the Executive through well-resourced Select Committees.

5. An impartial, diverse and professional Civil Service

- selected and promoted on merit
- appointed, at senior levels, by the Prime Minister on the advice of an independent appointments commission
- trained and accredited to the highest standards
- available to advise the Opposition in pre-Election periods.

PFO